



MOAR!

DEVELOPER

ZeniMax Online Studios

PUBLISHER

Bethesda Softworks

PLATFORMS

PlayStation 4, Xbox One, Microsoft Windows, Xbox Series X and Series S, macOS

PLAYED ON

Windows

PRICE

₹2,499

(including base game),

₹1,799

(if you already have the base game)



Scrolls Online, but, from what little we've played, the story in High Isle is a bit of a change in pace from the usual. This time around, the story is centred around regional politics; there's no apparent big bad that you need to deal with. It begins in Gonfalon Bay, where the Society of the Steadfast are holding a summit in the hopes of bringing the Three Banners War to an end. However, war being the money-making machine that it is, a group known as the Ascendant Order wants to make sure that peace is not an option. Sure, it doesn't sound all that epic on paper, but it's enjoyable enough. It felt like a breath of fresh air from the usual and as a plus, the voice acting and writing are top notch.

What's new in The Elder Scrolls Online: High Isle

In addition to a new region to explore, High Isle introduces two more companions that can join you while you quest – Isobel Velois and Ember. Isobel is a knight who believes in law and justice; actions you take that aren't in line with that will not sit right with her. Ember on the other hand is a streetwise mage

who believes that the end justifies the means. Both of them have excellent introductory quests which we accidentally stumbled upon.

Next we've got the new world events, the Volcanic fissures we spoke about earlier. These are similar to the Oblivion gates or Harrowstorms from previous expansions. Here, players' aid Stonelore druids to seal these fissures while fire Dae-dra pour out.

The expansion comes with a new 12-man trial, where you deal with the pirate threat to the Systres Archipelago. There are a host of new boss fights, items and achievements to be had.

High Isle also introduces a new card game, Tales of Tribute. Which we didn't get into too much, but we did go through a tutorial and we'll be honest, nothing stuck. Now we can't say it was complicated, but we weren't mentally prepared for another Gwent situation because some of us tend to become obsessed.

The Elder Scrolls Online: High Isle – Gameplay

There's nothing new in terms of gameplay. That's usually the case

with most MMO expansions when it comes to core gameplay mechanics. However, there have been a bunch of balance changes and tweaks, and we're sure there will be a lot more balance changes and tweaks in the future. Nothing new in terms of new classes or anything either. If you've played ESO in the past or even an Elder Scrolls game you should be fine. However, an issue we had with the game when it first launched and even now, remains to be the game's somewhat janky combat. Despite having more action and skill based combat, it can often feel unresponsive and slow in ESO.

Running around and questing is just as fun, and it's very easy to get sidetracked in High Isle, as you'll often come across side quests while you're in the middle of another quest. This could be a pro or a con for some, but hey that's the Elder Scrolls experience.

There's a lot of running around to be done, especially if you're a new player and haven't got a fast mount. That's one of those things that really irked us about ESO, being able to speed your mount up by 1% every 20 hours (oh and the crafting timers, ugh; yeah we're not even going to talk about crafting).

All that being said, there's nothing new here per se. It's a same-old-same-old situation. While we as relatively new players had a blast, returning veterans may be feeling some fatigue at this point. Speaking of which, we think High Isle is a great place for new players to start off, before they take on the rest of Tamriel.

The Elder Scrolls Online: High Isle: Verdict

The Systres Archipelago is a gorgeous new region to explore; the storytelling, writing, and voice acting is great. The gameplay is pretty much the same. There are a few new activities to do, and overall we'd say that we had fun playing High Isle and might stick around a bit longer this time around. *